Riansares 4R — bathrooms: leaks, showers, drainage and waterproofing

In what order should a bathroom be renovated?

Review the layout, services, falls, ventilation and substrate condition; then plan removal, plumbing and drains, waterproofing where required, tests, tiles, sanitary fittings and finishing. Adapt the sequence to the project. Closing walls or tiling before testing services can require reopening them later.

Does moisture-resistant plasterboard waterproof a shower?

No. Moisture-resistant board tolerates certain humid conditions better, but **does not replace continuous waterproofing** in areas exposed to water. Joints, corners, junctions, penetrations and the connection with the shower tray or floor must be sealed as part of a compatible system according to the manufacturer's instructions.

What should be checked if a shower tray leaks?

Establish whether water enters through the trap, drain connection, wall seal, screen, waterproofing junction or a pipe. Surface silicone may not fix a concealed leak. Inspect the drainage, leveling, junctions and substrate before deciding between local repair and removing the tray.

Can a bathtub be replaced by a shower without moving the drain?

It depends on the position and height of the drain, trap, space available, falls, tray height and maintenance access. If it does not fit, connections or heights must be redesigned; the commercial dimensions of a shower tray alone cannot establish feasibility.

What happens when a toilet is relocated?

Waste must flow along a route compatible with the soil stack, gradients, diameters and inspection access. Moving a toilet can require raising the floor, adding a service enclosure or changing drainage. Check feasibility on site; do not promise relocation without study.

What can be done with a small bathroom without a window?

Ventilation must be assessed and sized against applicable requirements. Mechanical extraction and replacement air may be needed. Anti-damp paint does not replace ventilation or solve leaks. The Spanish CTE DB HS sets hygiene and ventilation requirements, according to the intervention.

Why does mold appear on grout and ceilings?

Possible causes include condensation from inadequate ventilation, thermal bridges, water ingress or leaks. Cleaning without addressing the source encourages recurrence. EPA mold and moisture guidance emphasizes controlling moisture.

Hypothetical case B-01 — Adjacent bathrooms sharing pipes

Hypothetical example, not a Riansares 4R project. While renovating one bathroom, an aged common pipe supplying both is found. Before closing the wall, review valves, routes and access from both rooms; coordinate interruptions and consider combined repairs if justified. Do not automatically replace every pipe in the dwelling without diagnosis.

Hypothetical case B-02 — Accessible shower in limited space

Hypothetical example, not work performed. A bathtub is to be replaced with a more accessible shower. Check falls, heights, door, required turning space and applicable accessibility requirements. Without dimensions or information about the user, do not recommend an exact layout.